

PELICAN BAY POLICE DEPARTMENT
HOMICIDE DIVISION — EIGHTH DISTRICT
715 South Broad Avenue, New Orleans, LA 70119
(504) 658-6080

NEIGHBORHOOD CANVASS REPORT

Case No.: PBPD-2026-034532 | Document No.: 14

Reporting Officers: Officer James Martin (#3318); Officer Maria Thibodaux (#2241)

Supplemental Contact: Det. Renee Broussard (#1887)

Date of Report: October 7, 2025

Canvass Period: October 4, 2025 (initial, 04:00–09:00 AM) and October 5, 2025 (daytime, 11:00 AM–4:00 PM)

Area Canvassed: 700 block Bourbon Street, 1100 block Burgundy Street, north service alley access points

Persons Contacted: 27 (14 with statements taken; 13 declined or had nothing relevant)

I. CANVASS RESULTS — SUMMARY

#	Address / Business	Contact (name/role)	Relevance
1	714 Bourbon — Bayou Bistro	Felix Ortiz, dishwasher	Was on break with Washington earlier; corroborates alley smoke-break acc
2	714 Bourbon — Bayou Bistro	Sandra Pierce, line cook	Heard "voices arguing" in alley around 2:25 AM; thought it was "the usual."
3	710 Bourbon — Marie's	Dorian Beauchamp, bouncer	Saw three white males walk east on Bourbon at approx. 2:32 AM, "one in re
4	708 Bourbon — Voodoo Lounge	Kelsi Tran, bartender	No direct observation; recalls Cody Lefevre as a frequent customer earlier i
5	1102 Burgundy — residence	Anonymous (declined name)	Heard "thumps" from rear alley around 2:25-2:30 AM; thought it was kitchen
6	1108 Burgundy — Tante's Po-Boys	Manager R. Champagne	Confirms alley shortcut frequently used by service staff to access Burgundy
7	Bourbon @ St. Ann (street)	Marcus J., Lyft driver	Picked up three white males at corner of Bourbon and St. Ann at approx. 2:
8	Bourbon @ St. Ann (street)	Cherise Doucet, tourist (Lafayette)	Cell-phone video at 2:33 AM of street scene incidentally captures three mal

II. ANONYMOUS 911 CALLER — IDENTIFICATION

On October 6, 2025 at 1:42 PM, a female caller contacted the PBPD tip line (504-658-8888) and identified herself as **ELENA MARIA VARGAS**, age 26, residing in Houston, TX (DOB and full identifying info on file). Ms. Vargas stated she had been the anonymous 911 caller in this case. She was in New Orleans for a friend's bachelorette weekend, separated briefly from her group to return to her hotel via the Bourbon Street rear access, and witnessed the closing moments of the altercation from approximately 40 feet south of the body.

Ms. Vargas provided a recorded statement (Exhibit V-VAR-01) on October 6 at 4:18 PM at the PBPD Eighth District by telephone with Det. Broussard. Key points:

- She did not witness the initial blows.
- She saw three white males running north toward Bourbon as she approached.
- One was carrying "a stick — a bat, I think."
- She did not get good views of their faces; she identified only by clothing.
- She was initially afraid to come forward because she is undocumented and feared immigration consequences.

PBPD coordinated with the DA's Victim Witness Assistance Program to provide U-visa certification consideration.

- Ms. Vargas's TracFone was discarded after the 911 call; she purchased it for the trip after a phone-loss incident the prior weekend.

III. NEGATIVE RESULTS

Thirteen additional individuals were contacted with no relevant information. No additional witnesses to the assault itself were identified. Two adjacent businesses (Marie's, Voodoo Lounge) have rear-alley camera coverage that did not capture the assault location due to angle. Marie's footage of the Bourbon Street frontage at approximately 02:31 AM is consistent with witness statements regarding the three males' direction of travel and is retained as Exhibit V-MAR-01.

Reporting Officer: _____ Officer J. Martin #3318

Co-Officer: _____ Officer M. Thibodaux #2241

Supervisor Review: Sgt. Lamont Dupre, Eighth District — 10/07/2025